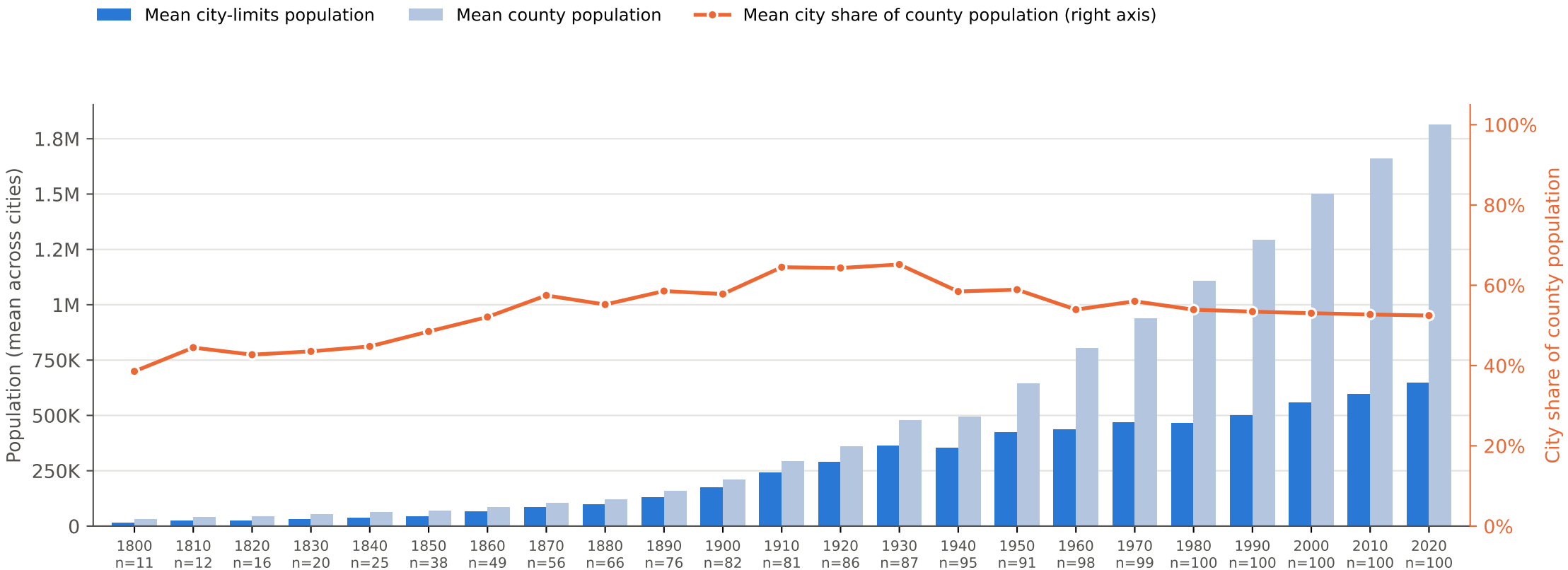
National average: city vs. county population, 1800–2020 (unweighted)

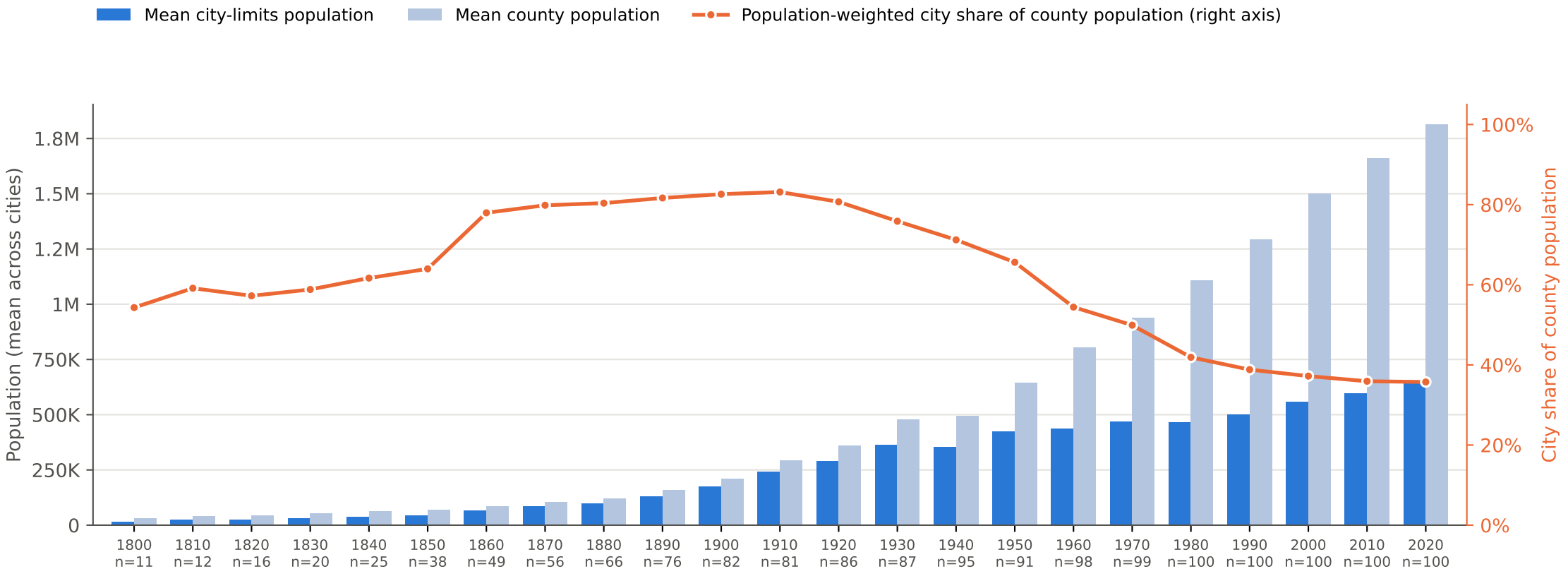
Top-100 contiguous-U.S. cities (2020), all 100 cities. Line: simple mean of city shares.



Each year averages only the cities with both a city and a county count that year (n under each year), so the sample grows over time and early years rest on few cities. Counties containing several of the cities count once per city. Consolidated city-counties (share near 100%) raise the averages.
Sources: decennial census counts (see README); city-level charts give per-city definitions and notes.

National average: city vs. county population, 1800–2020 (population-weighted)

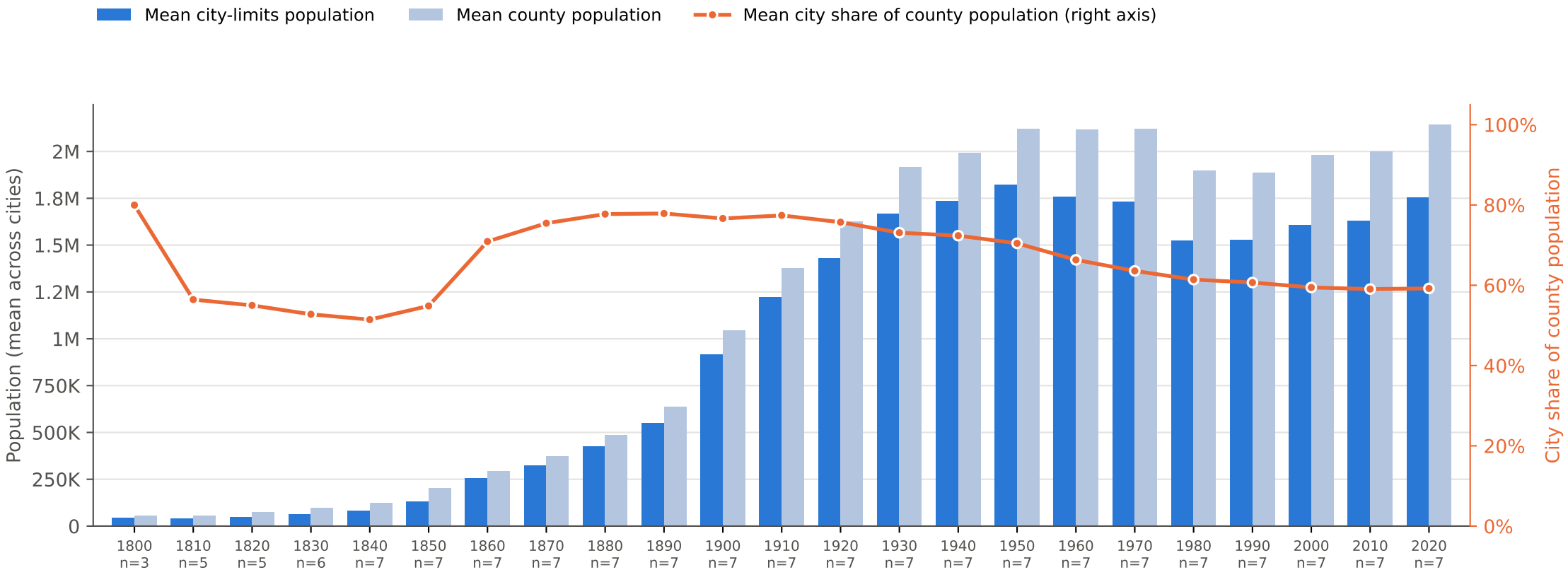
Top-100 contiguous-U.S. cities (2020), all 100 cities. Line: total city pop. ÷ total county pop. (ratio of the bars).



Each year averages only the cities with both a city and a county count that year (n under each year), so the sample grows over time and early years rest on few cities. Counties containing several of the cities count once per city. Consolidated city-counties (share near 100%) raise the averages.
New York's comparison area is its five boroughs (share 100%), and its size dominates this population-weighted average from 1900 on.
Sources: decennial census counts (see README); city-level charts give per-city definitions and notes.

Northeast region average: city vs. county population, 1800–2020 (unweighted)

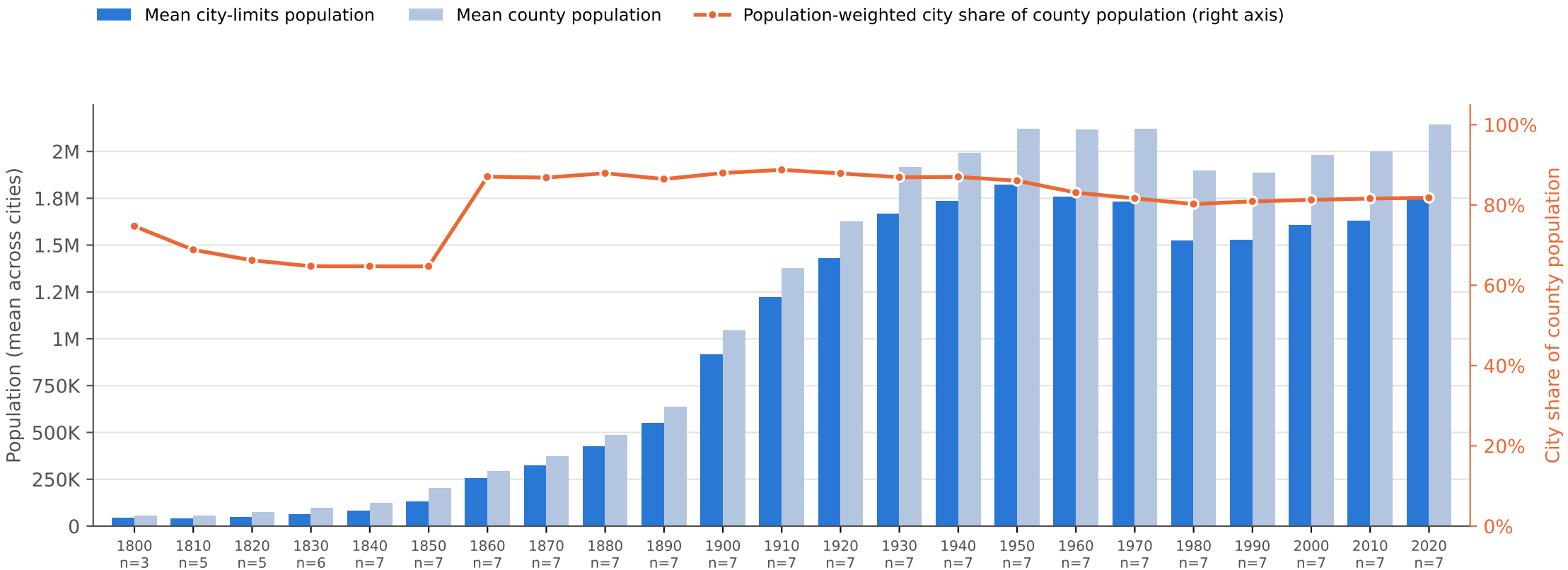
Top-100 contiguous-U.S. cities (2020), 7 cities in the Northeast. Line: simple mean of city shares.



Each year averages only the cities with both a city and a county count that year (n under each year), so the sample grows over time and early years rest on few cities. Counties containing several of the cities count once per city. Consolidated city-counties (share near 100%) raise the averages.
Northeast (U.S. Census region): New York, NY, Philadelphia, PA, Boston, MA, Newark, NJ, Pittsburgh, PA, Jersey City, NJ, Buffalo, NY.
Sources: decennial census counts (see README); city-level charts give per-city definitions and notes.

Northeast region average: city vs. county population, 1800–2020 (population-weighted)

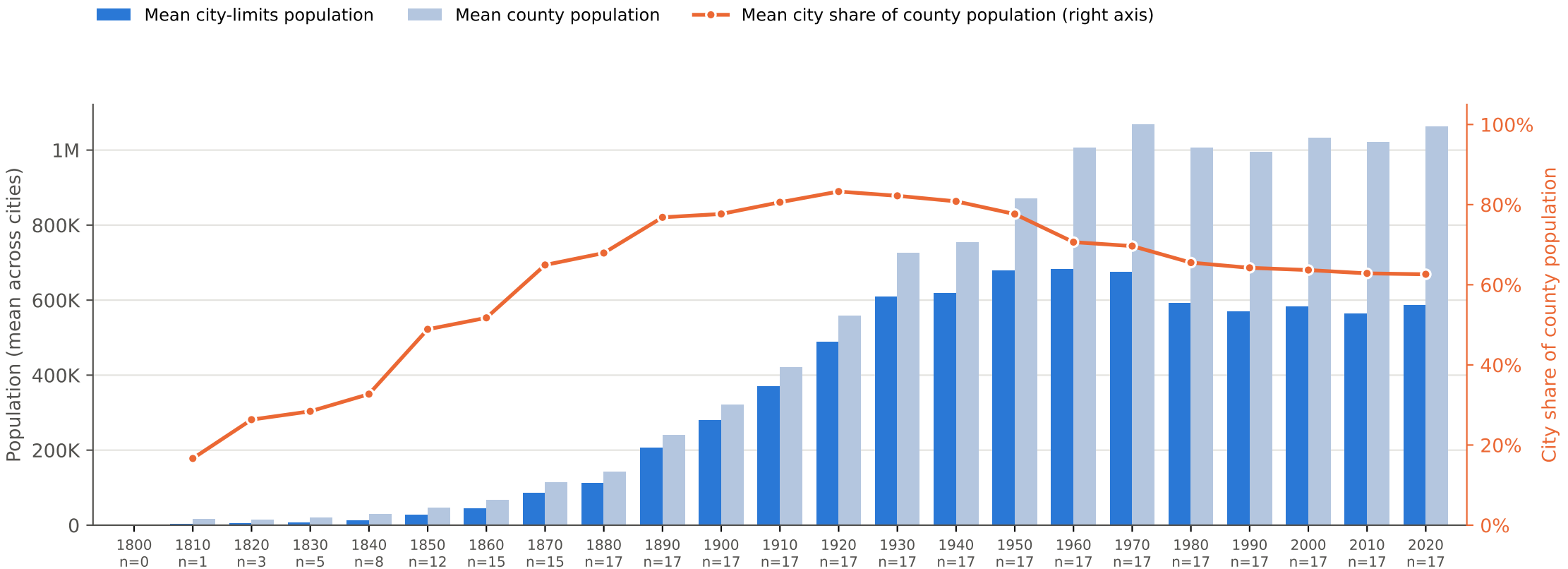
Top-100 contiguous-U.S. cities (2020), 7 cities in the Northeast. Line: total city pop. ÷ total county pop. (ratio of the bars).



Each year averages only the cities with both a city and a county count that year (n under each year), so the sample grows over time and early years rest on few cities. Counties containing several of the cities count once per city. Consolidated city-counties (share near 100%) raise the averages.
New York's comparison area is its five boroughs (share 100%), and its size dominates this population-weighted average from 1900 on.
Northeast (U.S. Census region): New York, NY, Philadelphia, PA, Boston, MA, Newark, NJ, Pittsburgh, PA, Jersey City, NJ, Buffalo, NY.
Sources: decennial census counts (see README); city-level charts give per-city definitions and notes.

Midwest region average: city vs. county population, 1800–2020 (unweighted)

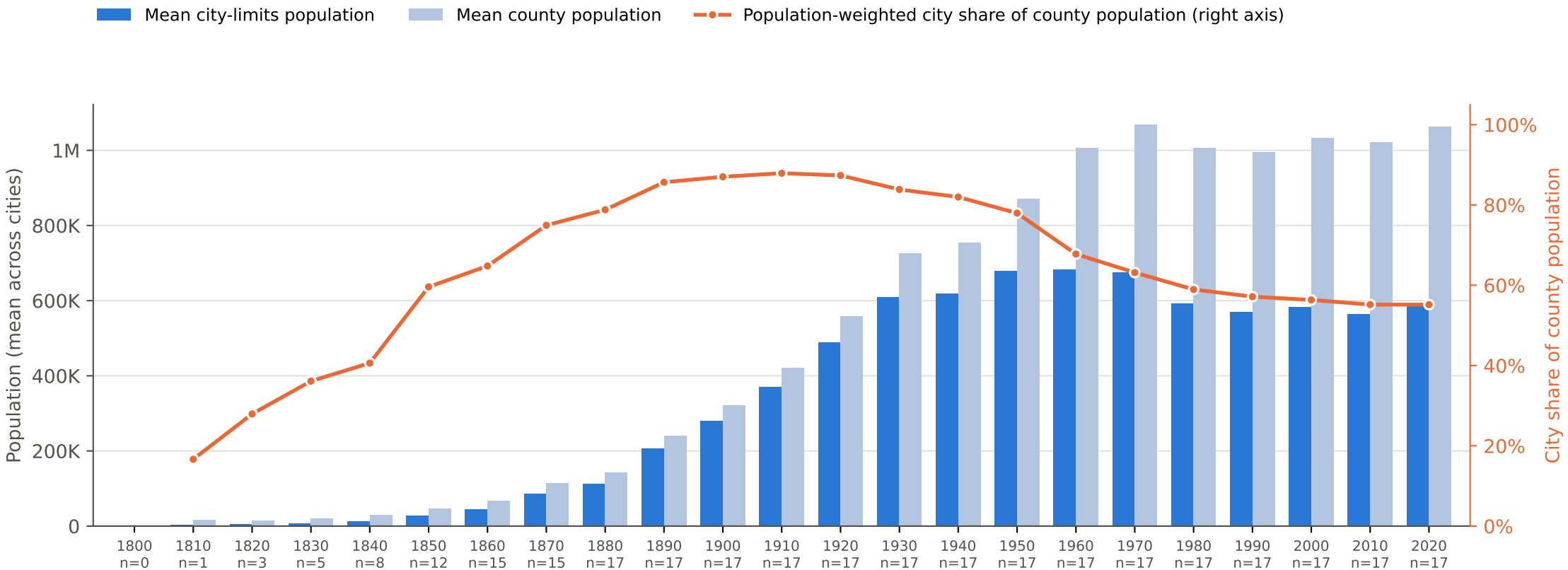
Top-100 contiguous-U.S. cities (2020), 17 cities in the Midwest. Line: simple mean of city shares.



Each year averages only the cities with both a city and a county count that year (n under each year), so the sample grows over time and early years rest on few cities. Counties containing several of the cities count once per city. Consolidated city-counties (share near 100%) raise the averages.
Midwest (U.S. Census region): Chicago, IL, Columbus, OH, Indianapolis, IN, Detroit, MI, Milwaukee, WI, Kansas City, MO, Omaha, NE, Minneapolis, MN, Wichita, KS, Cleveland, OH, St. Paul, MN, Cincinnati, OH, St. Louis, MO, Lincoln, NE, Toledo, OH, Madison, WI, Fort Wayne, IN.
Sources: decennial census counts (see README); city-level charts give per-city definitions and notes.

Midwest region average: city vs. county population, 1800–2020 (population-weighted)

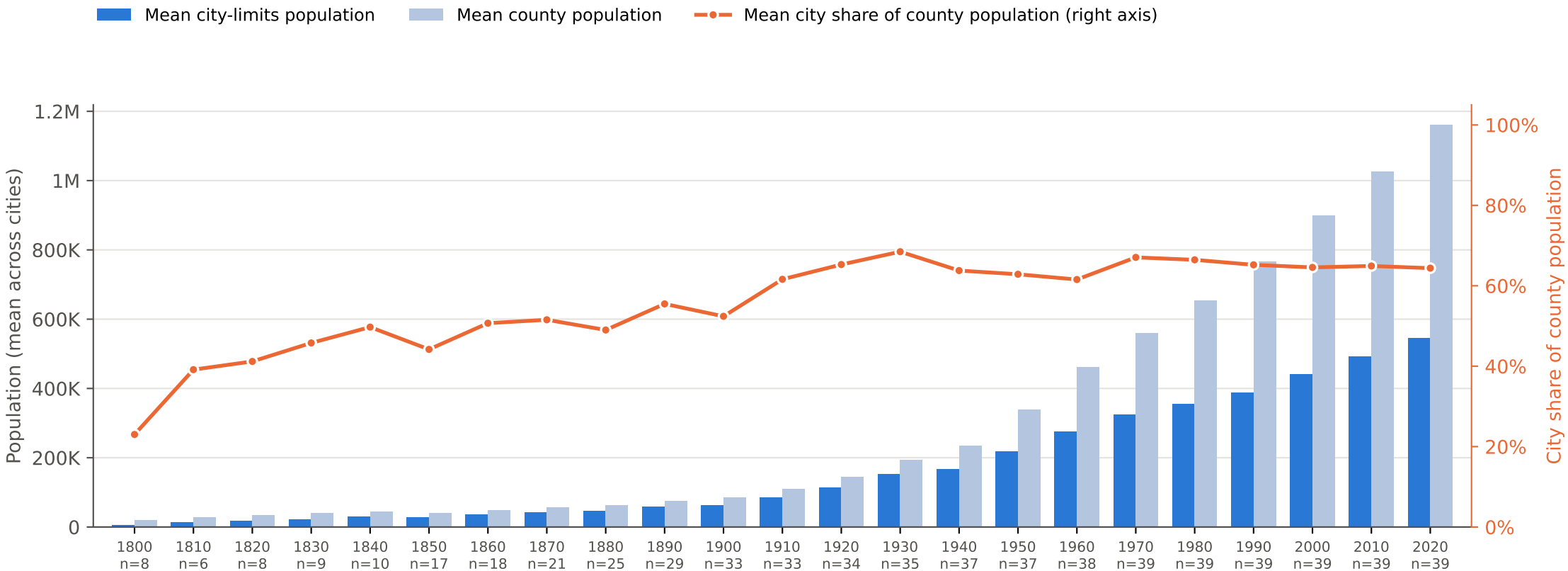
Top-100 contiguous-U.S. cities (2020), 17 cities in the Midwest. Line: total city pop. ÷ total county pop. (ratio of the bars).



Each year averages only the cities with both a city and a county count that year (n under each year), so the sample grows over time and early years rest on few cities. Counties containing several of the cities count once per city. Consolidated city-counties (share near 100%) raise the averages.
Midwest (U.S. Census region): Chicago, IL, Columbus, OH, Indianapolis, IN, Detroit, MI, Milwaukee, WI, Kansas City, MO, Omaha, NE, Minneapolis, MN, Wichita, KS, Cleveland, OH, St. Paul, MN, Cincinnati, OH, St. Louis, MO, Lincoln, NE, Toledo, OH, Madison, WI, Fort Wayne, IN.
Sources: decennial census counts (see README); city-level charts give per-city definitions and notes.

South region average: city vs. county population, 1800–2020 (unweighted)

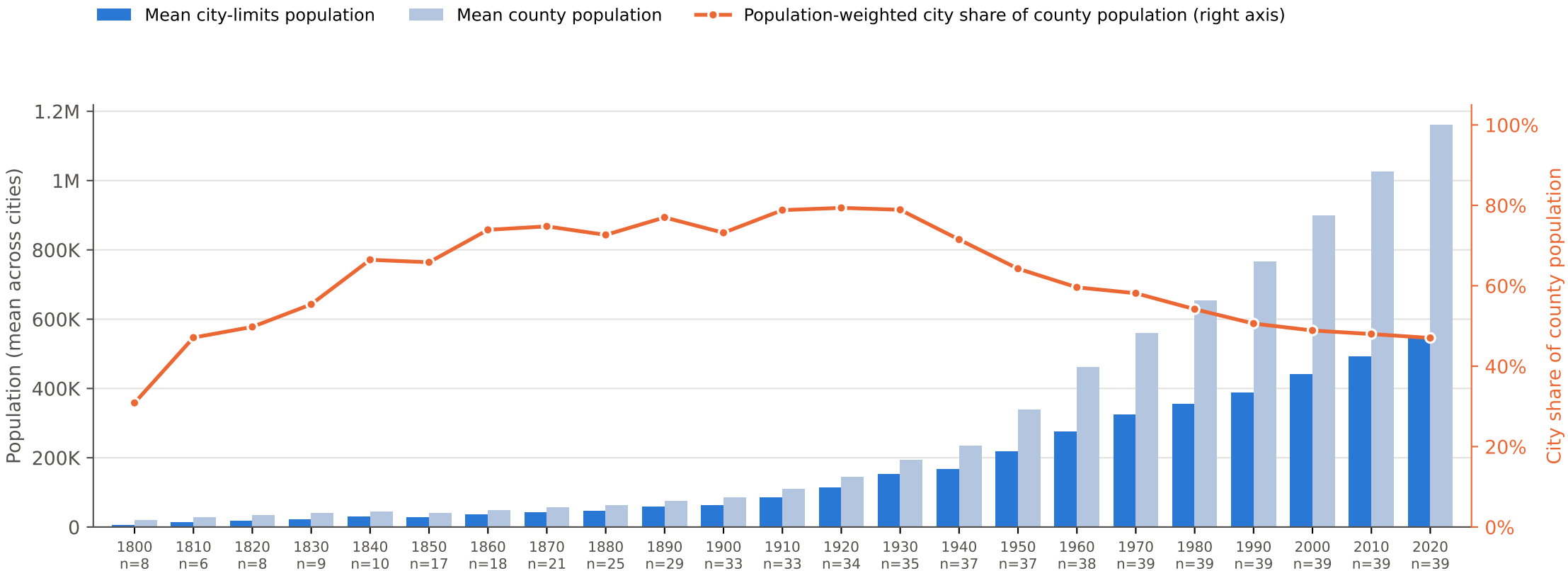
Top-100 contiguous-U.S. cities (2020), 39 cities in the South. Line: simple mean of city shares.



Each year averages only the cities with both a city and a county count that year (n under each year), so the sample grows over time and early years rest on few cities. Counties containing several of the cities count once per city. Consolidated city-counties (share near 100%) raise the averages.
South (U.S. Census region): Houston, TX, San Antonio, TX, Dallas, TX, Austin, TX, Jacksonville, FL, Fort Worth, TX, Charlotte, NC, Washington, DC, Nashville, TN, Oklahoma City, OK, El Paso, TX, Memphis, TN, Louisville, KY, Baltimore, MD, Atlanta, GA, Raleigh, NC, Virginia Beach, VA, Miami, FL, Tulsa, OK, Arlington, TX, Tampa, FL, New Orleans, LA, Lexington, KY, Corpus Christi, TX, Orlando, FL, Greensboro, NC, Plano, TX, Durham, NC, St. Petersburg, FL, Lubbock, TX, Irving, TX, Laredo, TX, Winston-Salem, NC, Chesapeake, VA, Garland, TX, Norfolk, VA, Baton Rouge, LA, Richmond, VA, Hialeah, FL.
Sources: decennial census counts (see README); city-level charts give per-city definitions and notes.

South region average: city vs. county population, 1800–2020 (population-weighted)

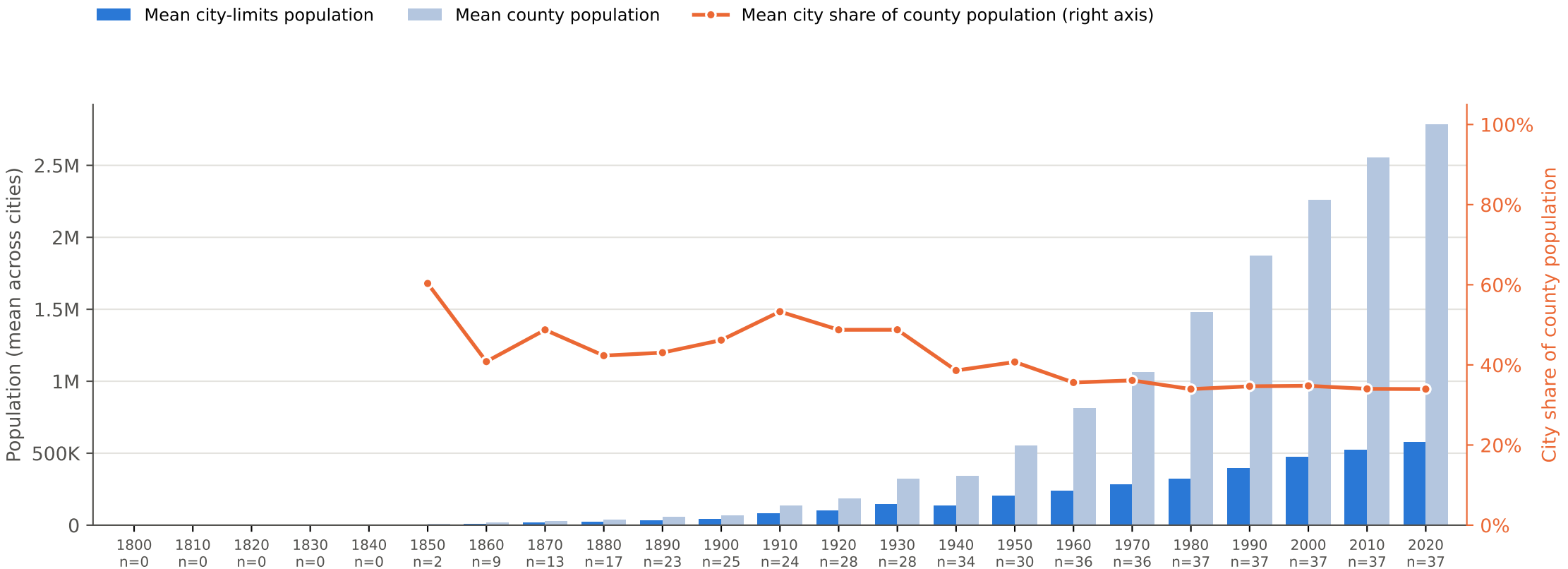
Top-100 contiguous-U.S. cities (2020), 39 cities in the South. Line: total city pop. ÷ total county pop. (ratio of the bars).



Each year averages only the cities with both a city and a county count that year (n under each year), so the sample grows over time and early years rest on few cities. Counties containing several of the cities count once per city. Consolidated city-counties (share near 100%) raise the averages.
South (U.S. Census region): Houston, TX, San Antonio, TX, Dallas, TX, Austin, TX, Jacksonville, FL, Fort Worth, TX, Charlotte, NC, Washington, DC, Nashville, TN, Oklahoma City, OK, El Paso, TX, Memphis, TN, Louisville, KY, Baltimore, MD, Atlanta, GA, Raleigh, NC, Virginia Beach, VA, Miami, FL, Tulsa, OK, Arlington, TX, Tampa, FL, New Orleans, LA, Lexington, KY, Corpus Christi, TX, Orlando, FL, Greensboro, NC, Plano, TX, Durham, NC, St. Petersburg, FL, Lubbock, TX, Irving, TX, Laredo, TX, Winston-Salem, NC, Chesapeake, VA, Garland, TX, Norfolk, VA, Baton Rouge, LA, Richmond, VA, Hialeah, FL.
Sources: decennial census counts (see README); city-level charts give per-city definitions and notes.

West region average: city vs. county population, 1800–2020 (unweighted)

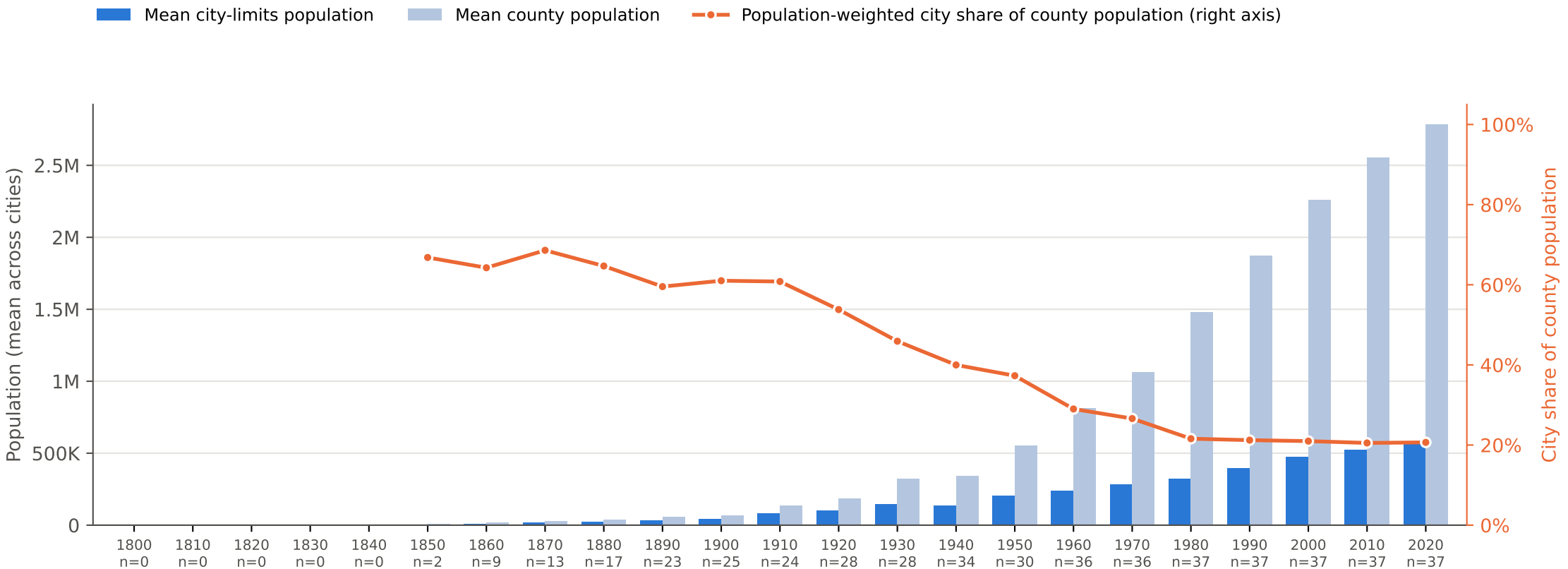
Top-100 contiguous-U.S. cities (2020), 37 cities in the West. Line: simple mean of city shares.



Each year averages only the cities with both a city and a county count that year (n under each year), so the sample grows over time and early years rest on few cities. Counties containing several of the cities count once per city. Consolidated city-counties (share near 100%) raise the averages.
West (U.S. Census region): Los Angeles, CA, Phoenix, AZ, San Diego, CA, San Jose, CA, San Francisco, CA, Seattle, WA, Denver, CO, Portland, OR, Las Vegas, NV, Albuquerque, NM, Tucson, AZ, Fresno, CA, Sacramento, CA, Mesa, AZ, Colorado Springs, CO, Long Beach, CA, Oakland, CA, Bakersfield, CA, Aurora, CO, Anaheim, CA, Stockton, CA, Henderson, NV, Riverside, CA, Santa Ana, CA, Irvine, CA, Chandler, AZ, Chula Vista, CA, Gilbert, AZ, Reno, NV, North Las Vegas, NV, Glendale, AZ, Scottsdale, AZ, Boise, ID, Fremont, CA, Spokane, WA, Santa Clarita, CA, San Bernardino, CA.
Sources: decennial census counts (see README); city-level charts give per-city definitions and notes.

West region average: city vs. county population, 1800–2020 (population-weighted)

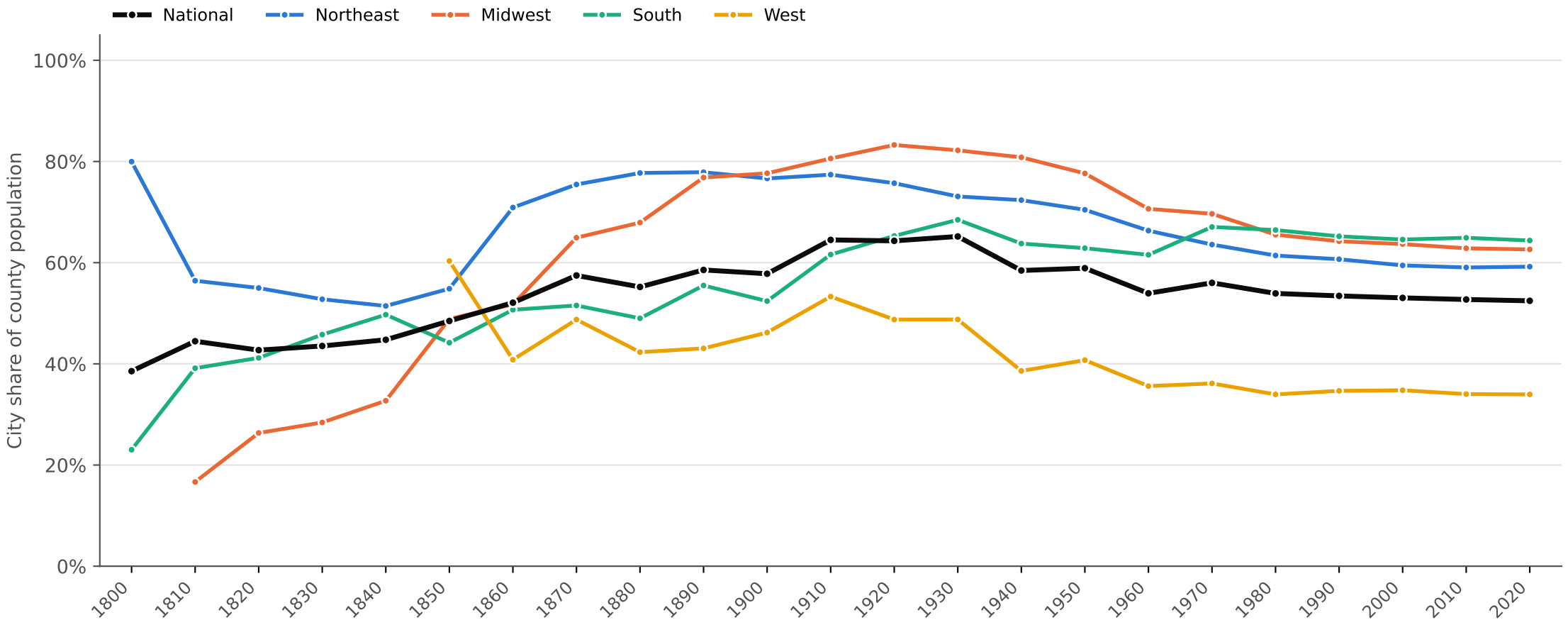
Top-100 contiguous-U.S. cities (2020), 37 cities in the West. Line: total city pop. ÷ total county pop. (ratio of the bars).



Each year averages only the cities with both a city and a county count that year (n under each year), so the sample grows over time and early years rest on few cities. Counties containing several of the cities count once per city. Consolidated city-counties (share near 100%) raise the averages.
West (U.S. Census region): Los Angeles, CA, Phoenix, AZ, San Diego, CA, San Jose, CA, San Francisco, CA, Seattle, WA, Denver, CO, Portland, OR, Las Vegas, NV, Albuquerque, NM, Tucson, AZ, Fresno, CA, Sacramento, CA, Mesa, AZ, Colorado Springs, CO, Long Beach, CA, Oakland, CA, Bakersfield, CA, Aurora, CO, Anaheim, CA, Stockton, CA, Henderson, NV, Riverside, CA, Santa Ana, CA, Irvine, CA, Chandler, AZ, Chula Vista, CA, Gilbert, AZ, Reno, NV, North Las Vegas, NV, Glendale, AZ, Scottsdale, AZ, Boise, ID, Fremont, CA, Spokane, WA, Santa Clarita, CA, San Bernardino, CA.
Sources: decennial census counts (see README); city-level charts give per-city definitions and notes.

Average city share of county population: national and Census regions (unweighted)

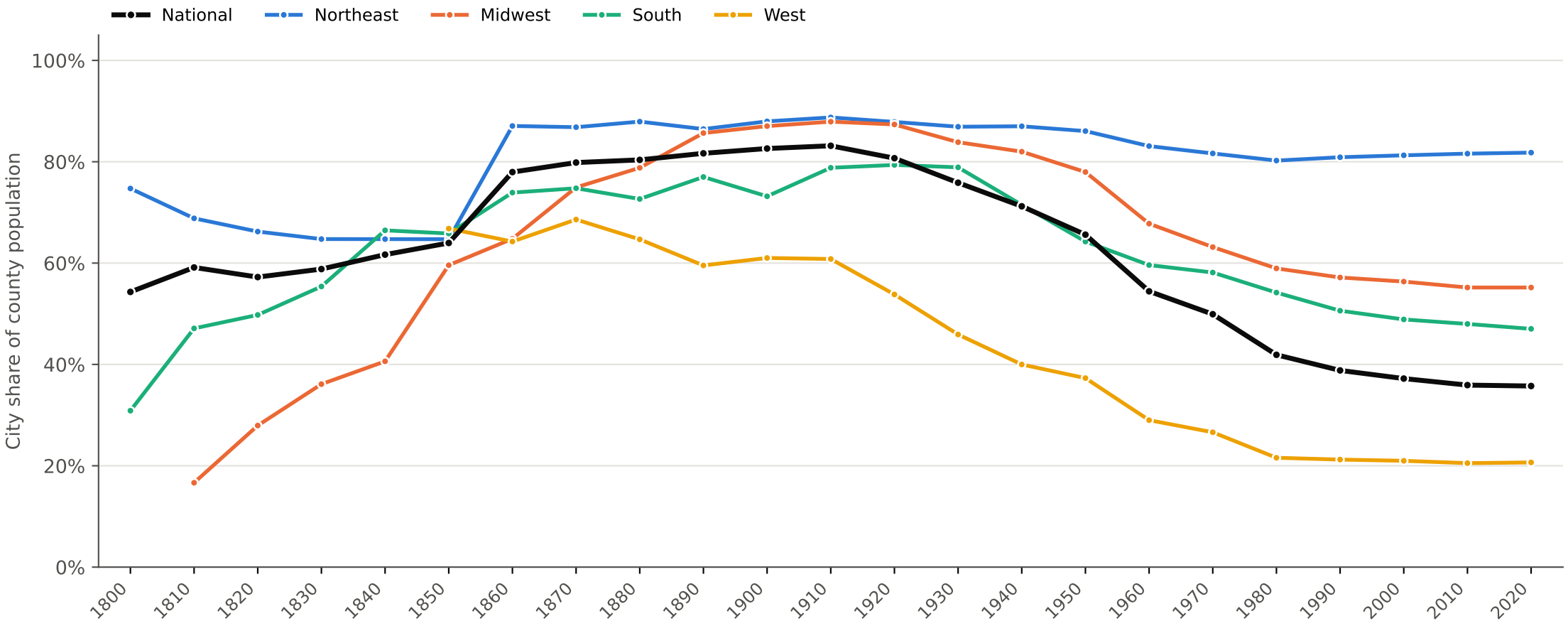
Top 100 contiguous-U.S. cities (2020). Simple mean of city shares; each year uses cities with both counts.



Early years rest on few cities per group (see the n counts in the group charts). Sources: decennial census counts (see README).

Average city share of county population: national and Census regions (population-weighted)

Top 100 contiguous-U.S. cities (2020). Shares weighted by county population (total city ÷ total county pop.); each year uses cities with both counts.



Early years rest on few cities per group (see the n counts in the group charts). Sources: decennial census counts (see README).